

Presidency Group of Institutions (PGI): A Legacy of Excellence, Values, and Global Education



Presidency Group of Institutions (PGI) in Bengaluru stands as a beacon of quality education in Karnataka, recognized for its immense contribution to shaping the future of students. With a legacy spanning over four decades, PGI is home to 8 schools, 3 Pre-University Colleges, an Autonomous College and a State Private University, where the focus is on practical, interdisciplinary learning that equips students to meet the challenges of a rapidly changing world. Under the visionary leadership of Dr. Nissar Ahmed, the Founder of PGI, the institution has touched the lives of thousands of students, preparing them not only to excel in their careers but also to embrace cultural values that define their character.

Dr. Nissar Ahmed's commitment to accessible education laid the foundation for PGI's growth, a legacy that continues with the next generation—Mr. Suhael Ahmed, Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed and Mr. Salman Ahmed, —who are steering PGI forward, blending tradition with modern education.

Dr. Nissar Ahmed: A Visionary Educator and Philanthropist

You are the visionary and driving force behind this over five-decade old educational group of institutions. What inspired you to embark on this journey of providing better education for the youth?

My passion for affordable education began in 1976, when my uncle, the late Mr. Abdul Hameed and I, established the first School. Our vision was clear: to create a chain of Institutions that provided education on par with top-tier Institutions. By 1980 we had established 2 Schools, and I lost my uncle in a tragic accident thereafter. His untimely death in 1980 led me to shoulder the entire responsibility of the Schools which then went on to expand into a chain of Schools

as there was a dearth of quality K-12 Institutions.

Subsequently, in the year 2000, I realized there was a dearth of good colleges in the city which led us to foray into higher education. As I expanded into higher education, I noticed a significant gap: students were not being adequately prepared for the industry. Over the past 25 years, Presidency College and, more recently, Presidency University, which is nearly a decade old, have worked tirelessly to offer modern education across various fields, with state-of-the-art infrastructure, laboratories, excellent faculty fraternity, focusing on developing professionals who possess the knowledge, skills, and competencies required to thrive in an ever-evolving world.

What evolution have you observed since the inception of PGI, and what impact has it had on individuals, society, and the industry over the decades?

In the early years, rote learning dominated the educational landscape, with teachers focusing mainly on theoretical knowledge, offering minimal practical or experiential exposure. Competition was intense, and success was measured solely by exam marks. This scenario extended into higher education as well.

The 1980s ushered in technology and computers, which significantly transformed teaching and learning. The focus shifted toward practical learning, and individuals began valuing multi-skill

